

Hugo Cruces | Empirical economist

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Joint Research Centre, European Commission

Professional Summary

Economist with a PhD and 4+ years of experience in distributional analysis and public policy evaluation at the European Commission's Joint Research Centre. Specialises in empirical analysis, microsimulation modelling and applied Artificial Intelligence.

Professional Experience

Joint Research Centre, European Commission

Seville, Spain

Economic Analyst & Team Leader

October 2021 – Present

- Develop and maintain the EUROMOD tax-benefit microsimulation model for EU-wide fiscal policy analysis
- Lead research team analysing distributional impact of health social transfers in-kind, in collaboration with DG SANTE
- Analysis of large and complex data (e.g., EU-SILC, HFCS, HBS) with advanced methods
- Conduct economic analyses for the European Semester, in collaboration with DG ECFIN, DG EMPL and DG TAXUD
- Communicate policy-actionable results in meetings, reports and technical documents

University of Vigo

Vigo, Spain

Adjunct Professor

February 2023 – May 2025

- Teach the course *Advanced Data Analysis*

University of Vigo

Vigo, Spain

Acting Professor

November 2020 – March 2021

- Taught the course *Economic History*

University of Vigo

Vigo, Spain

Predoctoral Researcher

January 2016 – October 2020

- Conducted research using microdata and advanced econometric and machine learning techniques

Education

University of Vigo

Spain

Ph.D. in Economics, Sobresaliente Cum Laude

February 2021

Complutense University of Madrid

Spain

M.A. in Economics

March 2015

University of Santiago de Compostela

Spain

B.A. in Economics

July 2012

Research

Peer-Reviewed Articles

2026: Escaping the Inactivity Trap? The Work Incentive of the Spanish Minimum Income. *Journal of Policy Modeling* 48(1): 107–129 (with A. Hernández and E. Narazani)

2026: Spain's Child Support Fails the Poor: Actionable Policy Reforms. *Applied Economics Letters*, forthcoming (with K. Bornukova, A. Hernández, and F. Picos)

2021: Issues on the Measurement of Opportunity Inequality. *Erasmus Journal for Philosophy and Economics* 15(1): 172–178

2019: Preference Orderings Representable By Utility Functions. *Journal of Economic Surveys* 33(1): 179–194 (with C. Hervés-Beloso)

Working Papers

2026: Unlocking Hidden Tax Revenues: Inheritance Taxation in Ageing Europe. *JRC Science for Policy Briefs, European Commission* (with S. Barrios and K. Grünberger)

2021: Households or Individuals? Gender and the Level of Analysis when Measuring Opportunity Inequality. *ECOBAS Working Papers*

2020: Using Capital Income to Proxy Family Background: An Application to Inequality of Opportunity. *ECOBAS Working Papers*

Reports

2025: The Role of Healthcare in Reducing Inequalities and Poverty in the EU. *European Commission, Directorate-General for Health and Food Safety* (main author)

2022: Regional Economic Outlook. Europe: the fog of war clouds the European outlook. *International Monetary Fund* (contributing author)

Technical Skills & Statistical Expertise

Statistical Software: **Expert:** Stata, EUROMOD | **Advanced:** R, gretl

Data analysis: Panel data, microsimulation modelling, machine learning

Programming: **Intermediate:** HTML/CSS, Bash, Git version control

Technical Writing: $\LaTeX$, Markdown, Microsoft Office suite

AI tools: IDEs, MCP servers, API integration, multi-agent systems design

Achievements

EPSO Competition: Placed on reserve list EPSO/AD/412/24 – Administrators in the field of Data and Statistics (AD6)

EPSO Competition: Placed on reserve list EPSO/AD/402/23 – Administrators in the field of Microeconomics/macroeconomics (AD6)

International Award: Aldi Harenaars Memorial Award 2020, LIS Cross-National Data Center

Languages

Spanish: Native

Galician: Native

English: Fluent

Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency in English

Italian: Intermediate

Events

2026: Presenter, *Automating social policy research with AI*, Federal Public Service Social Security, Belgium

2026: Workshop host, *Policy Modelling in EUROMOD with Generative AI*, IMA World Congress 2026, International Microsimulation Association, Brussels

2026: Instructor, *Using AI to Design Optimal Policies Under Fiscal Constraints*, Directorate-General for Economic and Financial Affairs (ECFIN) Summer School, European Commission

2026: Instructor, *Implementation of AI tools*, internal workshops for the Joint Research Centre, European Commission

2025: Roundtable speaker, *Acto Institucional 17 de octubre por el Día Internacional para la Erradicación de la Pobreza*, organised by the European Anti-Poverty Network Spain

2024: Roundtable speaker and discussion group coordinator, *Desafíos y horizontes de la garantía infantil en España*, organised by the European Commission and *La Caixa* Foundation

2024: Co-organizer, 6th JRC Fiscal Policy Modelling Workshop

2022–2024: Coordinator, Biweekly Academic Seminars, Fiscal Policy Analysis Unit (JRC.B2)

Last updated: September 30, 2026